XMTrading Japan Affiliate Competitor Analysis: Phased Delivery Plan

1. Purpose

This project will establish a central, repeatable and accessible competitor-intelligence capability for the XMTrading Japan affiliate product.

The capability will allow the wider XMTrading team to:

- view current competitor information in a consistent format;
- run competitor analyses without starting from zero;
- update competitor source material;
- compare competitors across agreed affiliate-product criteria;
- identify market gaps, threats and product opportunities;
- support product decisions with traceable evidence;
- monitor material changes in competitor programmes;
- reuse the same methodology for future competitors.

The project will use Gemini, custom Gems, Google Drive, Google Sheets and, in later phases, the Gemini API and workflow automation.

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2. Scope

2.1 XMTrading scope

The analysis concerns **XMTrading**, referred to in this document as **XMTD**.

XMTD is treated as a separate brand and product from XM.com and serves the Japanese market. Competitor analysis must therefore prioritise:

- Japanese-language affiliate propositions;
- features available to Japanese affiliates;
- conditions applicable to affiliates targeting Japan;
- Japanese affiliate perceptions and reviews;
- visibility on Japanese comparison and ranking websites;
- market practices relevant to Japanese affiliate acquisition and retention.

Global competitor information may be used as secondary context, but it must not automatically be treated as applicable to Japan.

2.2 Initial competitors

Competitor	Primary partner source
Exness	https://www.exnessaffiliates.com/

Competitor	Primary partner source
HFM	https://affiliates.hfm.com/
Vantage	https://partners.vantagemarkets.com/
FXGT	https://mypartners.fxgt.com/
Axiory	https://www.axiory.com/partnership and Japanese partner pages

Additional competitors may be added through the source-management process established in this plan.

2.3 Primary source categories

The analysis will initially use three source categories:

1. **Competitor terms and conditions**

2. Affiliate agreements

3. Introducing Broker agreements
4. CPA conditions
5. Revenue-share conditions
6. Promotion terms
7. Sub-affiliate conditions
8. Payment and withdrawal rules

9. Marketing and compliance restrictions

10. **Competitor partner pages**

11. Public partner landing pages

12. Commission pages
13. Programme descriptions
14. Partner dashboards or help-centre information
15. Promotional pages
16. Partner tools and resources
17. FAQs

18. Japanese-language partner pages

19. **Japanese affiliate ecosystem sources**

20. Affiliate review pages

21. Broker comparison pages
22. Affiliate toplists
23. Japanese blogs and specialist websites
24. Pages discussing affiliate commissions, payments, support and reputation
25. Search-result visibility for Japanese affiliate-related queries

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3. Guiding principles

3.1 Evidence before conclusions

Every material statement must be connected to a source. Gemini must not invent missing information or infer that a global condition applies to Japan without evidence.

3.2 Fact, claim and interpretation must be separated

The system must distinguish between:

- **verified fact:** directly supported by a primary source;
- **competitor claim:** a statement made by the competitor about itself;
- **affiliate opinion:** a statement made by an external reviewer;
- **analyst interpretation:** an internal conclusion based on the evidence;
- **unknown:** information that could not be verified.

For example, “industry-leading commission” is a competitor marketing claim, not a verified comparative fact.

3.3 Japanese-market relevance

Each finding must be assigned one of the following applicability statuses:

- Japan-specific;
- confirmed to apply globally, including Japan;
- global information with Japanese applicability not confirmed;
- not applicable to Japan;
- unclear.

3.4 Recency

Each source record must include:

- date accessed;
- publication or effective date, where available;
- last verified date;
- expected review frequency;
- current, potentially outdated or superseded status.

3.5 Human review

Gemini will accelerate collection, classification, summarisation and comparison. It will not replace legal, compliance, commercial or product review.

3.6 Reproducibility

Different team members should receive materially consistent results when analysing the same evidence and using the same framework.

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4. Target operating model

The completed capability will contain five connected layers.

Layer 1: Source library

A controlled collection of source documents, URLs, screenshots, PDFs and extracted text.

Layer 2: Structured competitor dataset

A Google Sheet or database containing comparable data points for every competitor.

Layer 3: XMTD Competitor Intelligence Gem

A shared Gem with approved instructions, analysis rules and reference material.

Layer 4: Confluence reporting layer

Human-readable competitor profiles, comparison tables, change reports and opportunity assessments.

Layer 5: Monitoring and automation

Scheduled source checks, change detection, structured extraction and alerts.

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5. Delivery roadmap

Phase 0 — Governance, access and framework definition

Objective

Establish the project rules before collecting or analysing competitor information.

Activities

1. Confirm which Google Workspace and Gemini features are available to the XMTD team.
2. Confirm whether shared Gems may be used internally.
3. Confirm Google Drive access and external-sharing restrictions.

4. Appoint the initial owners:

5. Product owner;

6. competitor-intelligence owner;
7. source owners;
8. legal or compliance reviewer;
9. technical owner for later automation.

10. Agree the initial analysis dimensions.
11. Agree naming conventions and source-storage rules.
12. Confirm how confidential XMTD information may be used with Gemini.
13. Create the Confluence parent page and project decision log.

Initial analysis dimensions

The following dimensions should be approved before Phase 1:

- programme types;
- CPA structure;
- revenue share or rebate structure;
- commission tiers;
- qualification criteria;
- sub-affiliate programme;
- sub-affiliate depth or number of levels;
- payment frequency;
- minimum withdrawal;
- payment methods;
- commission exclusions;
- negative carryover;
- attribution rules;
- cookie or tracking period;
- available tracking tools;
- custom postbacks;
- reporting and analytics;
- affiliate dashboard;
- marketing materials;
- localisation;
- Japanese support;
- affiliate-manager support;
- promotions and incentives;
- loyalty or status programmes;
- prohibited marketing activities;
- brand-bidding rules;
- social-media restrictions;
- regulatory restrictions;
- termination rights;
- post-termination commission treatment;
- affiliate reputation;
- Japanese toplist presence;
- major strengths;
- major weaknesses;
- relevant XMTD opportunities.

Deliverables

- Project charter
- Approved competitor list
- Approved analysis framework
- Roles and responsibilities
- Source-handling policy

- Gemini usage and confidentiality rules
- Confluence page structure

Acceptance criteria

- All required owners are identified.
- The analysis dimensions are approved.
- The team understands which information may be uploaded to Gemini.
- A single project location exists in Confluence and Drive.

Outcome and value

The team avoids inconsistent analysis, duplicated work and inappropriate handling of confidential information.

Phase 1 — Manual source register and document library

Objective

Create the simplest usable delivery: one central place where the team can find the known competitor sources.

Activities

Create the following Google Drive structure:

```
XMTD Competitor Intelligence
│
├── 00 Governance and Templates
├── 01 Exness
│   ├── Partner Pages
│   ├── Terms and Conditions
│   ├── Japanese Affiliate Reviews
│   ├── Japanese Toplists
│   ├── Screenshots
│   └── Archived Versions
├── 02 HFM
├── 03 Vantage
├── 04 FXGT
├── 05 Axiory
├── 06 Cross-Competitor Analyses
└── 07 Change Reports
```

Create a Google Sheet named **XMTD Competitor Source Register**.

Required source-register fields

Field	Description
Source ID	Unique identifier
Competitor	Exness, HFM, Vantage, FXGT or Axiory
Source category	Terms, partner page, review, toplist or other
Page or document title	Source title
URL	Direct source URL
Language	Japanese, English or other
Geographic scope	Japan, global or unclear
Programme type	CPA, IB, revenue share, hybrid, sub-affiliate or general
Publication/effective date	Where available
Date accessed	Date collected
Last verified	Most recent verification date
Source owner	Responsible person
File location	Drive link
Source status	Active, moved, removed, superseded or unknown
Reliability level	Primary, established secondary or unverified secondary
Notes	Important observations
Next review date	Planned review

Source collection rules

- Save PDFs where publicly downloadable.
- Save a PDF print or screenshot of important web pages.
- Record the original URL.
- Do not rely only on screenshots where selectable text or a PDF is available.
- Save Japanese and English versions separately.
- Do not overwrite old terms and conditions; archive them.
- Record redirects and moved pages.
- Mark login-only information clearly.
- Record when information was supplied by an affiliate manager rather than observed publicly.

Deliverables

- Google Drive source library
- Source-register template
- Initial competitor URLs
- Initial set of terms, partner pages and Japanese review sources
- Source gap list

Acceptance criteria

- Every competitor has a folder.
- Every saved document has a corresponding source-register row.
- Every source has a date accessed and geographic scope.
- Missing source categories are visible in the gap list.

Outcome and value

Any team member can locate the available evidence without repeating the same searches.

Phase 2 — Standardised competitor data matrix

Objective

Convert the source collection into structured, comparable competitor data.

Activities

Create a Google Sheet named **XMTD Affiliate Competitor Matrix**.

Use one row per competitor and criterion where practical. For complex terms, use one row per individual finding.

Recommended structure

Field	Purpose
Finding ID	Unique reference
Competitor	Competitor name
Analysis category	Commission, tracking, support, terms, reputation, etc.
Data point	Specific criterion
Finding	Normalised answer
Raw source wording	Relevant extracted wording
Source ID	Link to source register
Source URL	Direct URL
Source type	Primary or secondary
Japan applicability	Status
Effective date	Where known
Last verified	Verification date
Confidence	High, medium or low
Evidence status	Verified, claim, opinion, interpretation or unknown

Field	Purpose
Analyst notes	Context
XMTD relevance	Why it matters
Review status	Draft or approved
Reviewer	Reviewer name

Normalisation rules

Use controlled values wherever possible.

Examples:

Payment frequency

- daily;
- weekly;
- monthly;
- on request;
- unclear.

Sub-affiliate depth

- none;
- one level;
- two levels;
- three or more levels;
- unspecified multi-level;
- unclear.

Japan applicability

- Japan-specific;
- confirmed for Japan;
- global—Japan not confirmed;
- not applicable;
- unclear.

Confidence

- high: direct and current primary source;
- medium: reliable but indirect, incomplete or potentially outdated;
- low: unverified secondary source or substantial ambiguity.

Deliverables

- Competitor data dictionary
- Standard matrix
- Controlled vocabulary
- First completed baseline for all five competitors

- List of unknown or non-comparable fields

Acceptance criteria

- The same criteria are applied to all competitors.
- Every finding has at least one source.
- Unknown information is marked as unknown rather than omitted.
- Japan applicability is recorded.
- Marketing claims are not presented as objective facts.

Outcome and value

The team can compare competitors on a like-for-like basis instead of reading multiple unstructured pages.

Phase 3 — Gemini-assisted source extraction

Objective

Use Gemini to accelerate document reading and data extraction while keeping the source matrix under human control.

Activities

1. Upload one source or one closely related source set at a time.
2. Ask Gemini to extract information using the approved schema.
3. Require quotations or precise source passages.
4. Require explicit treatment of missing information.
5. Require a distinction between Japanese and global terms.
6. Have a human reviewer validate the output before it enters the approved matrix.
7. Record extraction errors and improve the prompt.

Prompt: extract a competitor source

```
You are supporting the XMTrading Japan affiliate product team.

Analyse only the attached source material. Do not use general knowledge or
make assumptions.

Extract information relevant to the competitor's affiliate or partner
programme.

For every finding, return the following fields:

1. Competitor
2. Source title
3. Source category
4. Analysis category
5. Data point
6. Normalised finding
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7. Exact supporting passage
8. Page number or section heading
9. Geographic applicability
10. Japan applicability
11. Effective or publication date
12. Evidence status:
   - verified fact;
   - competitor claim;
   - external opinion;
   - analyst interpretation;
   - unknown
13. Confidence:
   - high;
   - medium;
   - low
14. Ambiguity or limitation
15. Suggested XMTD relevance

Rules:

- Do not infer that global terms apply to Japan.
- Do not convert marketing language into objective facts.
- Do not calculate a value unless the required inputs are expressly provided.
- If information is absent, write “Not stated in the supplied source”.
- If two sections conflict, report both and flag the conflict.
- Preserve monetary currencies and original units.
- Do not translate a legal term in a way that changes its meaning.
- Return the results as a table suitable for copying into Google Sheets.
```

Prompt: extract terms and conditions

```
Review the attached affiliate agreement or partner terms.

Create a clause-level summary covering:

- contracting entity;
- eligibility;
- affiliate obligations;
- prohibited activities;
- paid-search and brand-bidding restrictions;
- domain and social-media restrictions;
- client qualification conditions;
- commission calculation;
- commission exclusions;
- payment timing;
- payment thresholds;
- chargebacks or clawbacks;
- sub-affiliate rights;
- tracking and attribution;
- data and reporting access;
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- intellectual-property use;
- confidentiality;
- amendment rights;
- suspension;
- termination;
- post-termination commission treatment;
- governing law;
- dispute resolution;
- Japan-specific provisions.

For each item provide:

- concise summary;
- exact supporting passage;
- clause or page reference;
- practical affiliate impact;
- possible XMTD comparison point;
- ambiguity or missing information.

Do not provide legal advice. Do not infer provisions that are not present.
```

Deliverables

- Approved source-extraction prompt
- Approved terms-extraction prompt
- Extraction review checklist
- Gemini-assisted baseline extraction
- Prompt error log

Acceptance criteria

- Test extractions correctly identify supporting passages.
- Reviewers can trace each result to the source.
- Missing information is not fabricated.
- The extraction time per source is measurably reduced.
- Human review remains mandatory before publication.

Outcome and value

The team processes more source material while retaining evidence traceability and review control.

Phase 4 — Shared XMTD Competitor Intelligence Gem

Objective

Create a shared Gem that applies the same competitor-analysis methodology for the whole product team.

Proposed Gem name

XMTD Japan Affiliate Competitor Analyst

Gem purpose

The Gem will:

- answer questions about approved competitor material;
- produce structured competitor comparisons;
- identify source gaps;
- summarise changes;
- create competitor profiles;
- assess possible XMTD opportunities;
- generate drafts for Confluence;
- refuse to invent unsupported competitor data.

Gem knowledge files

The Gem should initially receive:

- project charter;
- competitor definitions;
- data dictionary;
- analysis framework;
- source register;
- approved competitor matrix;
- approved baseline reports;
- evidence-classification rules;
- output templates;
- glossary of affiliate terminology;
- Japanese market and applicability rules.

Large collections of raw source files should remain organised in Drive. The Gem should receive the most relevant approved reference files rather than an uncontrolled document dump.

Master Gem instructions

```
You are the XMTD Japan Affiliate Competitor Analyst.

Your users are members of the XMTrading product, affiliate, commercial,
compliance and management teams.

CONTEXT

XMTrading, abbreviated as XMTD, is analysed as a separate brand from XM.com
and serves the Japanese market.

The initial competitors are:

- Exness;
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- HFM;
- Vantage;
- FXGT;
- Axiory.

PRIMARY PURPOSE

Help the XMTD team analyse affiliate competition in the Japanese market using
approved source material.

You may:

- compare competitors;
- summarise competitor terms;
- create competitor profiles;
- analyse Japanese affiliate reviews and toplists;
- identify differences;
- identify source gaps;
- draft Confluence reports;
- identify possible product opportunities;
- produce questions for further investigation;
- summarise material changes between source versions.

EVIDENCE RULES

1. Base factual answers on the supplied knowledge files and sources.
2. Never invent a commission, feature, condition, date or market practice.
3. Distinguish:
   - verified fact;
   - competitor claim;
   - external affiliate opinion;
   - analyst interpretation;
   - unknown.
4. Do not assume that global information applies to Japan.
5. State the source title, source ID and last verified date for material
findings.
6. When sources conflict, show the conflict rather than selecting one
silently.
7. Clearly flag information that may be outdated.
8. State “Not established from the available evidence” when appropriate.
9. Treat competitor marketing statements as claims unless independently
verified.
10. Do not expose confidential XMTD information in competitor-facing
recommendations.

ANALYSIS RULES

When comparing competitors:

- use the same criteria for every competitor;
- distinguish “not offered” from “not found”;
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- separate programme availability from programme quality;
- account for Japan relevance;
- identify the strongest supporting evidence;
- avoid ranking competitors where data is incomplete;
- explain the basis for any score;
- provide confidence levels.

OPPORTUNITY RULES

When identifying opportunities for XMTD:

- connect each opportunity to evidence;
- explain the affiliate problem addressed;
- identify the affected affiliate segment;
- estimate impact only where evidence permits;
- distinguish quick wins from strategic investments;
- identify dependencies and risks;
- do not recommend copying a competitor without assessing XMTD fit.

DEFAULT OUTPUT

Unless the user asks for another format, answer using:

1. Executive summary
2. Evidence-based findings
3. Comparison table
4. Japan-specific implications
5. Opportunities for XMTD
6. Risks and limitations
7. Missing information
8. Sources used
9. Recommended next action

LANGUAGE

Respond in English unless asked to respond in Japanese.

When analysing Japanese sources:

- retain important original Japanese terms;
- provide an English explanation;
- flag ambiguous translations;
- do not translate brand, programme or legal terminology inaccurately.

LEGAL AND COMPLIANCE

You may summarise public terms and identify differences, but you must not
present your output as legal advice. Recommend legal or compliance review
where the conclusion depends on interpretation of contractual or regulatory
language.
```

Gem testing scenarios

The Gem must be tested against at least the following:

1. Compare all competitors' sub-affiliate models.
2. Identify which competitors offer daily payments.
3. Explain what is confirmed specifically for Japan.
4. Compare termination provisions.
5. Summarise Japanese affiliate sentiment.
6. Identify sources not verified in the last 90 days.
7. Produce a competitor profile from approved data.
8. Respond to a question for which the data is missing.
9. Handle conflicting sources.
10. Prevent unsupported rankings.
11. Distinguish a competitor claim from an independently verified feature.
12. Analyse a newly uploaded source without overwriting approved findings.

Deliverables

- Shared Gem
- Gem instruction document
- Knowledge-file inventory
- Test script
- Test results
- Known limitations
- User guide

Acceptance criteria

- Authorised team members can access the Gem.
- The Gem follows the agreed output structure.
- It cites the internal source identifiers.
- It does not invent missing data in test cases.
- It distinguishes Japan-specific information.
- At least two independent reviewers approve the test results.

Outcome and value

The entire product team gains a common interface for accessing competitor intelligence without needing to understand the full source library.

Phase 5 — Standard analysis and Confluence report templates

Objective

Make the Gem operational for recurring product and management use cases.

Standard reports

A. Competitor profile

One page per competitor containing:

- executive summary;
- Japanese market positioning;
- programme types;
- commission model;
- sub-affiliate model;
- payments;
- tools and reporting;
- partner support;
- promotions;
- key contractual terms;
- Japanese affiliate reputation;
- strengths;
- weaknesses;
- open questions;
- XMTD implications;
- source freshness.

B. Cross-competitor comparison

Comparison of all competitors against the approved framework.

C. Feature deep dive

Focused analysis of one area, such as:

- sub-affiliation;
- custom postbacks;
- affiliate dashboards;
- commission tiers;
- affiliate status programmes;
- reporting;
- payment experience;
- Japanese localisation.

D. Japanese affiliate perception report

Analysis of review and toplist sources covering:

- recurring positive themes;
- recurring complaints;
- perceived commission attractiveness;
- payment reputation;
- support reputation;
- platform reputation;
- ranking visibility;

- possible affiliate-selection factors.

E. Source gap report

Shows what is unknown, outdated or insufficiently supported.

F. Monthly change report

Shows additions, removals or material changes since the previous review.

Prompt: full competitor profile

```
Create an evidence-based competitor profile for [COMPETITOR].

Use only approved sources.

Cover:

- Japanese market relevance;
- programme types;
- commission proposition;
- qualification criteria;
- sub-affiliate model;
- payments;
- tracking and reporting;
- affiliate tools;
- support;
- promotions and incentives;
- important contractual restrictions;
- Japanese affiliate perceptions;
- strengths;
- weaknesses;
- unknowns;
- opportunities and threats for XMTD.

For every material finding, include the source ID and last verified date.

Clearly distinguish:

- verified information;
- competitor marketing claims;
- external reviewer opinions;
- internal interpretation.

End with:

1. three most important findings;
2. three unanswered questions;
3. three possible XMTD implications.
```

```
Format the result for publication in Confluence.
```

Prompt: feature comparison

```
Compare Exness, HFM, Vantage, FXGT and Axiory in relation to [FEATURE].

Use the same evaluation criteria for every competitor.

Return:

1. Definition and scope of the feature
2. Comparison table
3. Evidence for each competitor
4. Japan applicability
5. Source confidence
6. Data gaps
7. Strongest competitor proposition
8. Most important market pattern
9. Potential gap for XMTD
10. Recommended follow-up research

Do not treat “not found” as proof that the feature is not offered.
Do not rank competitors where the available evidence is materially unequal.
```

Prompt: Japanese affiliate review analysis

```
Analyse the supplied Japanese affiliate review and toplist sources.

For each competitor identify:

- number and type of sources;
- ranking positions where stated;
- recurring positive themes;
- recurring negative themes;
- commission-related comments;
- payment-related comments;
- support-related comments;
- platform or tracking comments;
- repeated claims appearing across multiple websites;
- signs that content may be promotional or commercially influenced;
- contradictions between sources;
- issues requiring primary-source verification.

Do not assume that repeated wording across websites represents independent
confirmation.

Separate:
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- directly observed statement;
- reviewer opinion;
- inferred market perception;
- analyst conclusion.

Provide the result in English, retaining important Japanese expressions where
relevant.
```

Prompt: opportunity assessment

```
Using the approved competitor evidence, identify potential improvements for
the XMTD affiliate product.

For each opportunity provide:

- opportunity title;
- observed competitor or market evidence;
- affiliate problem addressed;
- target affiliate segment;
- proposed XMTD response;
- expected value;
- implementation complexity:
  - low;
  - medium;
  - high;
- likely dependencies;
- legal or compliance considerations;
- data required before prioritisation;
- recommended validation method;
- confidence level.

Classify each opportunity as:

- parity requirement;
- differentiator;
- retention improvement;
- acquisition improvement;
- operational improvement;
- experiment.

Do not recommend a feature solely because a competitor advertises it.
```

Deliverables

- Confluence template library
- Standard Gem prompt library
- Baseline competitor profiles
- Baseline comparison report
- Baseline Japanese affiliate perception report

Acceptance criteria

- Reports follow a consistent structure.
- Data can be traced to sources.
- Reports identify unknowns and limitations.
- Product stakeholders can find relevant information without reviewing raw documents.
- Reports can be refreshed using the same process.

Outcome and value

Competitor intelligence becomes a repeatable product process rather than a collection of one-off research tasks.

Phase 6 — Controlled source-update workflow and change analysis

Objective

Allow team members to add and update sources without compromising data quality.

Proposed update workflow

1. Contributor submits a new source.
2. Source is added to the source register.
3. Source is saved in the correct Drive folder.
4. Gemini performs initial classification and extraction.
5. Gemini compares the source against the current approved record.
6. A human reviewer validates the change.
7. Approved data is updated.
8. The relevant competitor profile is refreshed.
9. Material changes are added to the change log.
10. Stakeholders are notified where necessary.

Source submission fields

- competitor;
- URL or document;
- source category;
- language;
- reason for submission;
- date found;
- suspected change;
- submitter;
- urgency;
- whether the page is public or login-restricted.

Prompt: classify a new source

```
Classify this newly submitted source for the XMTD competitor-intelligence
library.

Return:

- competitor;
- source category;
- language;
- geographic scope;
- Japan relevance;
- programme type;
- likely reliability;
- whether it is primary or secondary;
- publication or effective date;
- whether it appears current;
- analysis categories affected;
- recommended review priority;
- suggested file name;
- suggested Drive folder;
- duplicate-source risk;
- information requiring human validation.

Do not analyse unsupported topics beyond the source.
```

Prompt: detect changes between source versions

```
Compare the OLD VERSION and NEW VERSION of this competitor source.

Identify only substantive changes.

For every change provide:

- section or clause;
- old wording;
- new wording;
- change type:
  - added;
  - removed;
  - amended;
  - relocated;
  - unclear;
- concise explanation;
- likely affiliate impact;
- Japan relevance;
- affected competitor-matrix fields;
- severity:
  - informational;
```

```
  - minor;
  - material;
  - critical;
- required reviewer:
  - product;
  - affiliate;
  - legal;
  - compliance;
  - technical.

Ignore formatting-only changes unless they affect meaning.
Do not infer legal effect beyond the text.
```

Prompt: source freshness audit

```
Review the source register and produce a source-freshness audit.

Group sources into:

- current;
- review due within 30 days;
- overdue;
- URL inaccessible;
- possibly superseded;
- missing effective date;
- missing owner;
- missing archived copy.

Prioritise sources based on:

1. importance to competitor comparison;
2. likelihood of change;
3. age;
4. whether the source concerns commissions, payments, qualification or
termination;
5. Japan relevance.

Return an action list by owner.
```

Deliverables

- Source-submission process
- Update checklist
- Version-comparison prompt
- Change log
- Review queue
- Source-freshness dashboard

Acceptance criteria

- Team members can submit sources using one process.
- Old versions are retained.
- Changes are not published without review.
- Material changes are linked to affected findings.
- Source ownership and review dates are visible.

Outcome and value

The competitor library remains maintainable and current rather than becoming a static research archive.

Phase 7 — Scoring, trends and product-opportunity prioritisation

Objective

Turn structured competitor evidence into decision-support tools without hiding uncertainty.

Proposed scorecard dimensions

Possible dimensions include:

- commission attractiveness;
- payment convenience;
- sub-affiliate capability;
- tracking and analytics;
- partner tools;
- Japanese localisation;
- partner support;
- contractual flexibility;
- promotional support;
- affiliate reputation;
- transparency;
- retention mechanisms.

Scoring principles

- Every score must have a written rationale.
- Scores must be based on defined criteria.
- Unknown information must not receive a zero.
- “No evidence” must remain distinct from “feature absent”.
- Primary-source and secondary-source evidence should not carry equal weight.
- Japan-specific evidence should carry more weight for XMTD decisions.
- Score changes must be versioned.
- The raw evidence must remain accessible.

Example scoring scale

Score	Meaning
1	Materially weak based on adequate evidence
2	Below observed market standard
3	Broadly comparable with market
4	Strong proposition
5	Leading proposition based on adequate comparative evidence
N/A	Not applicable
Unknown	Insufficient evidence

Opportunity prioritisation model

Each opportunity may be assessed against:

- affiliate value;
- expected retention impact;
- expected acquisition impact;
- differentiation potential;
- Japanese-market relevance;
- evidence strength;
- implementation effort;
- technical dependency;
- operational dependency;
- compliance risk;
- time to value.

Prompt: evidence-based scoring

```
Score the competitors against the approved scoring framework.

Rules:

- Apply the rubric exactly.
- Provide the evidence behind every score.
- Use “Unknown” where evidence is insufficient.
- Do not score “not found” as zero.
- Give greater evidential weight to current Japan-specific primary sources.
- Identify where scores are not reliably comparable.
- Show confidence separately from the score.
- Do not calculate an overall winner unless data completeness is sufficient.

Return:

1. category score;
2. rationale;
```

```
3. source IDs;
4. Japan applicability;
5. confidence;
6. missing evidence;
7. sensitivity note explaining what could change the score.
```

Prompt: prioritise product opportunities

```
Prioritise the approved XMTD affiliate-product opportunities.

Assess each opportunity against:

- Japanese affiliate value;
- expected retention impact;
- expected acquisition impact;
- competitive urgency;
- differentiation potential;
- evidence strength;
- implementation complexity;
- dependency risk;
- compliance risk;
- time to value.

Return:

- score by criterion;
- total weighted score;
- rationale;
- evidence;
- assumptions;
- information still required;
- recommended category:
  - now;
  - next;
  - later;
  - monitor;
  - reject.

Perform a sensitivity check showing whether the recommendation changes if the
two most uncertain scores are reduced.
```

Deliverables

- Approved scoring framework
- Competitor scorecard
- Opportunity backlog
- Prioritisation methodology
- Trend report

Acceptance criteria

- Stakeholders understand how every score was calculated.
- Unknown data is not penalised as feature absence.
- Scores link to evidence.
- At least one sensitivity check is included.
- Product opportunities can be moved into discovery with defined hypotheses.

Outcome and value

Competitor analysis begins to support prioritisation and roadmap decisions while preserving transparency about uncertainty.

Phase 8 — Gemini API and workflow automation

Objective

Automate repetitive parts of source monitoring, extraction and reporting.

Potential architecture

```
Approved URL list
      ↓
Scheduled retrieval or monitoring
      ↓
Content snapshot and version storage
      ↓
Change detection
      ↓
Gemini structured extraction
      ↓
Validation rules
      ↓
Human review queue
      ↓
Approved competitor dataset
      ↓
Confluence / Sheets dashboard / alerts
```

Potential automated workflows

1. Check whether registered URLs remain accessible.
2. Detect page or PDF changes.
3. Extract changed data into a predefined JSON schema.
4. Compare new findings with approved values.
5. generate a review task.
6. Alert owners to high-severity changes.
7. Produce a draft monthly report.

8. identify sources approaching their review dates.
9. flag competitor claims appearing across multiple Japanese affiliate sites.
10. generate structured competitor profiles from approved records.

Example structured-output schema

```
{
  "competitor": "",
  "source_id": "",
  "source_title": "",
  "source_date": "",
  "last_checked": "",
  "japan_applicability": "",
  "changes": [
    {
      "category": "",
      "data_point": "",
      "old_value": "",
      "new_value": "",
      "supporting_text": "",
      "location": "",
      "severity": "",
      "confidence": "",
      "human_review_required": true
    }
  ]
}
```

Automation controls

- Use an approved URL allowlist.
- Respect website terms, access controls and applicable technical restrictions.
- Do not attempt to bypass logins, anti-bot controls or restricted access.
- Keep raw snapshots for auditability.
- Validate generated JSON before writing to the dataset.
- Prevent automated overwriting of approved records.
- Require human approval for material changes.
- Log prompts, model versions, timestamps and processing status.
- Apply rate limits and failure handling.
- Maintain a manual fallback process.

Deliverables

- Technical feasibility assessment
- Approved solution design
- API extraction schema
- Monitoring prototype
- Review queue
- Automated draft change report
- Error and audit logs

Acceptance criteria

- The prototype identifies known test changes.
- Structured output passes schema validation.
- Failed or ambiguous extractions enter a review queue.
- Approved data is not overwritten automatically.
- Source and processing history are retained.
- Technical, security and legal stakeholders approve production use.

Outcome and value

Manual monitoring effort is substantially reduced, and important competitor changes become visible earlier.

Phase 9 — Advanced competitor-intelligence service

Objective

Create a mature, governed intelligence service embedded in product planning.

Potential capabilities

- searchable competitor knowledge base;
- conversational competitor analysis through the Gem;
- scheduled competitor profiles;
- automated source-freshness monitoring;
- change alerts;
- Japanese search-visibility tracking;
- Japanese affiliate-theme analysis;
- historical commission and programme timelines;
- product-gap heatmaps;
- evidence-based opportunity backlog;
- quarterly competitor reviews;
- management summaries;
- integration with product-discovery and roadmap processes.

Suggested recurring outputs

Frequency	Output
Weekly	Material source-change alert
Monthly	Competitor change digest
Monthly	Source-freshness and gap report
Quarterly	Full cross-competitor review
Quarterly	Japanese affiliate perception review
Quarterly	XMTD opportunity refresh

Frequency	Output
Ad hoc	Feature deep dive or competitor profile

Outcome and value

Competitor intelligence becomes an ongoing organisational capability informing affiliate-product strategy, discovery, retention initiatives and roadmap prioritisation.

---

6. Recommended Confluence structure

```
XMTD Affiliate Competitor Intelligence
│
├── 1. Overview and Governance
│   ├── Project Charter
│   ├── Scope and Definitions
│   ├── Roles and Responsibilities
│   ├── Methodology
│   └── Decision Log
│
├── 2. Source Library
│   ├── Source Register
│   ├── Source Gaps
│   └── Source Freshness
│
├── 3. Competitor Profiles
│   ├── Exness
│   ├── HFM
│   ├── Vantage
│   ├── FXGT
│   └── Axiory
│
├── 4. Cross-Competitor Analysis
│   ├── Master Comparison
│   ├── Commission Models
│   ├── Sub-Affiliation
│   ├── Payments
│   ├── Tracking and Reporting
│   ├── Partner Tools
│   ├── Support and Localisation
│   └── Terms and Restrictions
│
├── 5. Japanese Affiliate Ecosystem
│   ├── Affiliate Review Analysis
│   ├── Toplist Analysis
│   ├── Search Visibility
│   └── Affiliate Needs and Complaints
```

```
│
├── 6. Product Opportunities
│   ├── Opportunity Backlog
│   ├── Prioritisation
│   ├── Discovery Questions
│   └── Experiments
│
├── 7. Change Monitoring
│   ├── Monthly Change Reports
│   ├── Material Alerts
│   └── Historical Timeline
│
└── 8. Gemini and Gem Resources
    ├── User Guide
    ├── Gem Instructions
    ├── Prompt Library
    ├── Test Cases
    └── Known Limitations
```

---

7. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Main responsibilities
Product Manager	Owns roadmap, methodology and stakeholder alignment
Competitor Intelligence Owner	Maintains source register, matrix and reports
Affiliate Team	Validates commercial relevance and affiliate-market context
Japanese Market Reviewer	Reviews language, cultural context and Japan applicability
Legal/Compliance	Reviews legal terms, restrictions and regulatory implications
Product Analysts	Support data structure, scoring and trend analysis
Technical Owner	Owns API, monitoring and automation in later phases
Contributors	Submit new sources and identify suspected changes
Confluence Owner	Maintains publication structure and access

A single person may hold several roles during the early phases.

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8. Quality-control checklist

Before publishing a finding, confirm:

- Is the competitor correctly identified?
- Is the source primary or secondary?

- Is the source current?
- Is the source URL recorded?
- Is the original document archived?
- Is the source Japanese, global or another regional version?
- Is Japan applicability confirmed?
- Is the statement a fact, claim, opinion or interpretation?
- Is the exact supporting passage available?
- Are currencies and units preserved?
- Is missing information marked clearly?
- Were conflicting sources identified?
- Was the finding reviewed by the appropriate owner?
- Is the XMTD implication supported rather than speculative?
- Does the report avoid disclosing confidential XMTD information?

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9. Success measures

Adoption

- Number of active team users
- Number of Gem analyses run
- Number of Confluence competitor pages viewed
- Number of teams using the outputs

Efficiency

- Average time to complete a competitor profile
- Average time to process a new source
- Reduction in duplicated competitor research
- Percentage of reports generated using standard templates

Coverage

- Percentage of competitors with complete baseline profiles
- Percentage of criteria with verified data
- Percentage of sources reviewed on time
- Number of unresolved data gaps

Quality

- Percentage of findings with traceable sources
- Human-review rejection or correction rate
- Number of unsupported-output incidents
- Number of outdated findings discovered after publication

Product impact

- Number of discovery initiatives supported
- Number of roadmap decisions informed

- Number of competitor-derived hypotheses validated
- Number of affiliate improvements implemented
- Retention or acquisition outcomes linked to implemented improvements

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10. Recommended delivery sequence

Priority	Phase	Indicative result
1	Phase 0	Governance and agreed framework
2	Phase 1	Searchable source library
3	Phase 2	Comparable competitor matrix
4	Phase 3	Faster Gemini-assisted extraction
5	Phase 4	Shared XMTD competitor Gem
6	Phase 5	Repeatable Confluence reports
7	Phase 6	Controlled update and change process
8	Phase 7	Scoring and opportunity prioritisation
9	Phase 8	API-based monitoring and extraction
10	Phase 9	Mature competitor-intelligence service

Each phase should be usable independently. Later phases should not be started before the underlying sources, taxonomy and review process are sufficiently reliable.

---

11. Recommended first delivery milestone

The first delivery should contain:

1. the approved competitor list;
2. the Drive folder structure;
3. the source register;
4. the initial source collection;
5. the competitor data dictionary;
6. the first version of the competitor matrix;
7. one pilot competitor profile;
8. the source-extraction prompt;
9. the initial Gem instructions;
10. a documented list of source and capability gaps.

The pilot competitor should be selected based on the availability of Japanese partner pages, accessible terms and sufficient Japanese affiliate-review coverage.

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12. Key risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Gemini fabricates missing information	Strict prompts, source citations and human review
Global terms are mistaken for Japanese terms	Mandatory Japan-applicability field
Competitor pages change without notice	Archived copies, last-verified dates and monitoring
Review sites repeat sponsored claims	Source classification and independence assessment
Different analysts use different criteria	Controlled taxonomy, Gem and report templates
Shared Gem contains outdated files	Named knowledge owner and scheduled reviews
Automation overwrites approved findings	Human approval and separate draft/approved states
Terms are interpreted as legal advice	Legal review and explicit limitations
Too much data reduces usability	Prioritised dimensions and executive summaries
Scores create false precision	Evidence rationale, confidence and unknown values
Login-only information cannot be verified	Record provenance and access limitations
Public-source collection breaches site restrictions	Approved collection process and legal/technical review

13. Final intended state

At maturity, an authorised XMTD team member should be able to ask:

> “Compare the sub-affiliate propositions of XMTD’s main Japanese-market competitors, identify changes since the previous quarter, explain which claims are confirmed for Japan, and propose evidence-based retention opportunities.”

The system should return:

- a structured comparison;
- the source behind every important finding;
- source dates and confidence levels;
- Japan-specific limitations;
- changes from the previous period;
- product implications;
- missing information;
- recommended next steps.

This represents the end goal: a reusable, governed and evidence-based competitor-intelligence capability available to the entire XMTD product team.